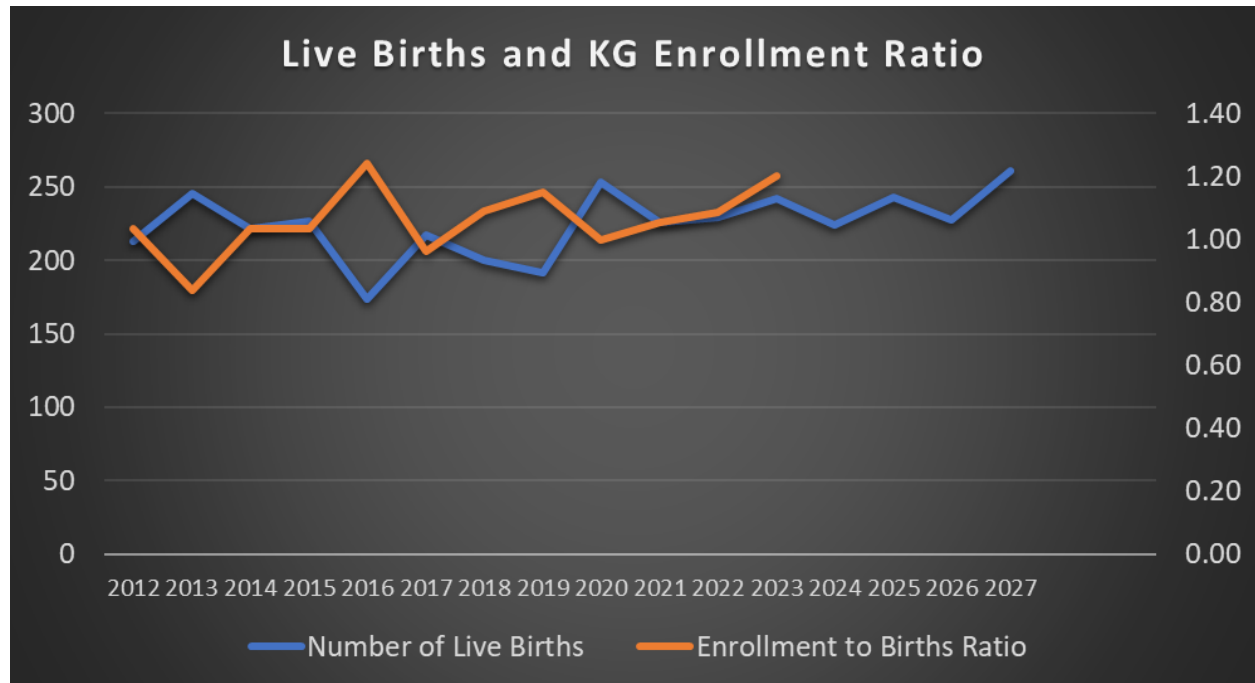




The purpose of this study is to build upon and update the prior enrollment studies completed for Brecksville-Broadview Heights City School District. This report will analyze the following data to allow the district to make meaningful decisions:

- Live Births vs Kindergarten Enrollment
- Enrollment Trends
- Cohort Analysis - 2018-2023
- New Housing Data

Live Births vs Kindergarten Enrollment



Source: Ohio Department of Health

Brecksville-Broadview Heights City School District experiences very little variation in live births to kindergarten enrollment. Since 2012, the District has averaged 1.04 students enrolled per each live birth. The measurement year is the year in which enrollment is expected. Therefore, a live birth occurring in 2022 can be expected to enroll in kindergarten in 2027. This indicates that each birth occurring within Brecksville-Broadview Heights limits can be expected to enroll in kindergarten.



Projecting Future Enrollment

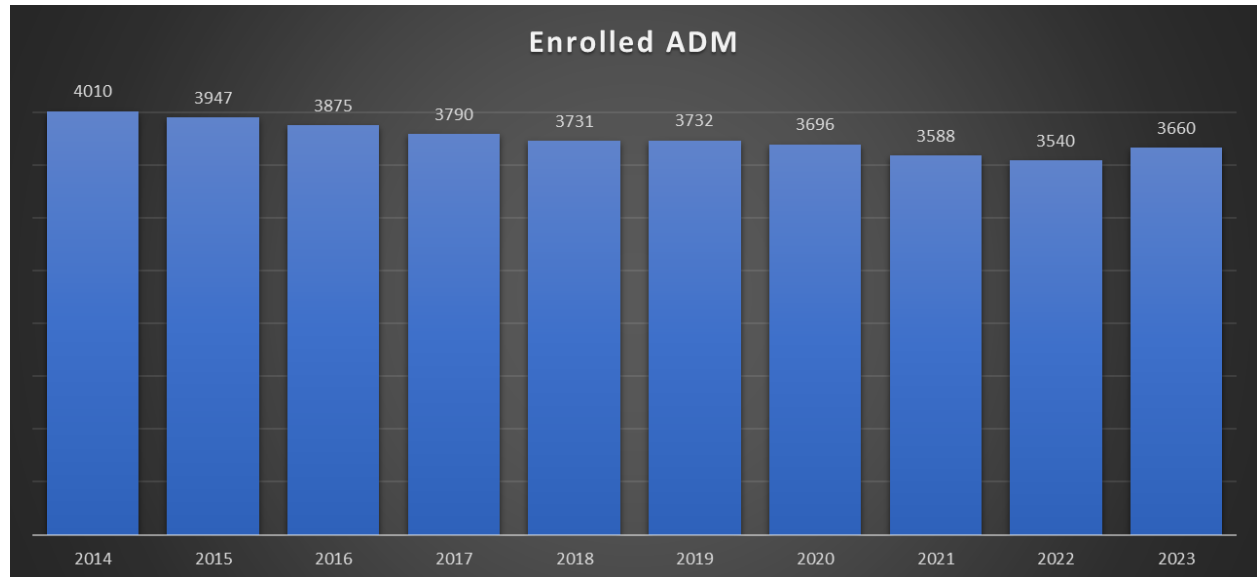
While there are many factors impacting future kindergarten enrollment, Brecksville-Broadview Heights is in a unique position. With the new preK-5 building, there has been increased community interest in enrolling young students in the public school system. In addition, while there were early projections of large growth in live births during COVID, latest reports from the Ohio Department of Health indicate that live births in Cuyahoga County decreased from 2020 to 2021. Preliminary data for 2022 birth rates show a slight tick up.

Another factor impacting current and future kindergarten enrollment is parents holding back their students from enrolling into kindergarten during the pandemic. Most students should have returned this year, which is part of the reason we see such a large jump in kindergarten enrollment in the 2022-23 school year. There are 62 students in this current kindergarten class who were of age to start kindergarten last year. While this does not account for the entire increase, we also see an increase in live births in 2017, leading to a larger number of eligible children for this kindergarten class.

Actual Enrollment							Projected Enrollment			
2017	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026	2027
209	218	221	253	238	249	291	233	253	237	271

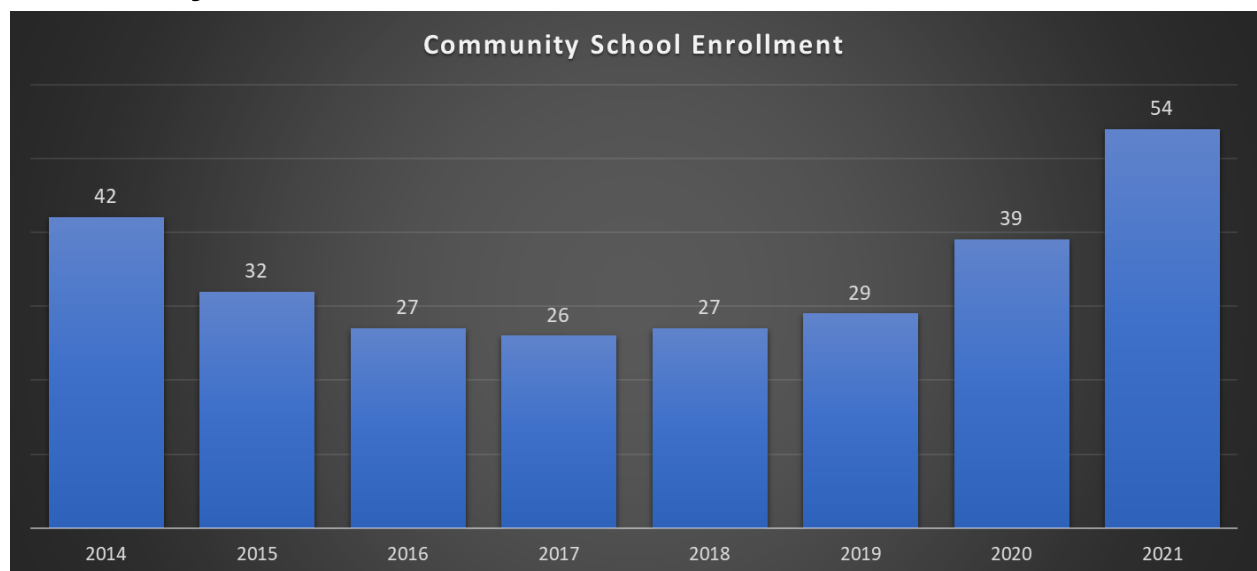


Enrollment Trends



Enrollment data from 2014-2022 shows a steady decline in enrollment with a tick-up in 2022-23.

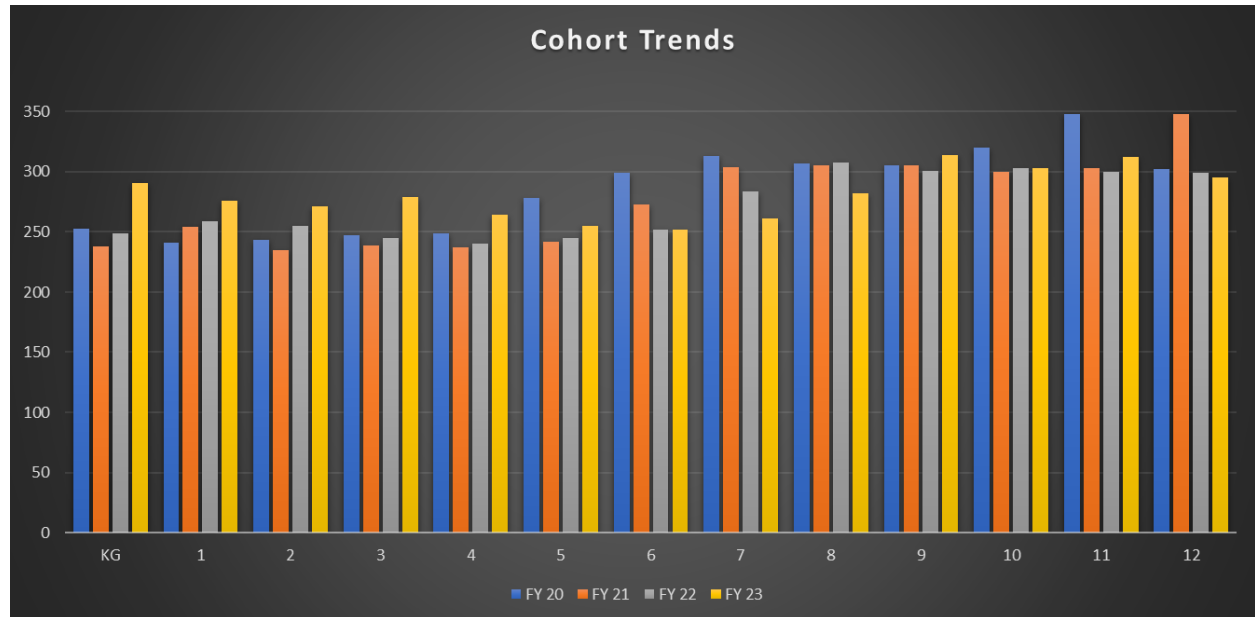
Community School Enrollment



Source: ODE Enrollment Data; District enrollment data



Cohort Analysis



Source: ODE Enrollment Data

The graphic above shows grade by grade enrollment from 2019-20 through 2022-23 school years. While there are a few outliers, enrollment by grade has stayed relatively consistent through the pandemic. Two areas to watch for in the near future are the incoming kindergarten enrollment and the increase in 3rd grade students over the last few school years.

Additional analysis shows that 62 kindergarten students in 2022-23 were of age to start kindergarten last year, resulting in an influx of students this year.



Cohort Analysis (cont.)

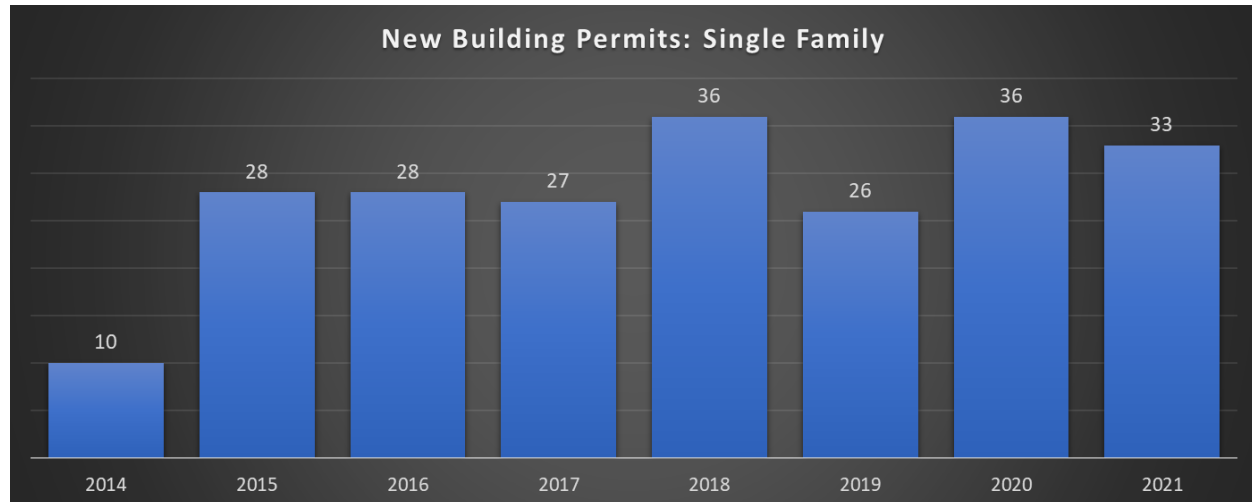
The following table illustrates the District's enrollment from 2017-18 through 2022-23. The cells in Green follow the class of 2023 from 7th grade until 12th grade. As can be seen, the variation in enrollment year over year is minimal, with the largest change occurring from 8th to 9th grade, an increase of 11 students. Following other classes, we can see that, as a whole, enrollment varies very little from grade to grade. The largest year over year variance we see is with the incoming kindergarten students in the 2022-23 school year, an increase of 42 students over the 2021-22 school year, which is actually students delaying kindergarten a year due to COVID-19.

	2017-18	2018-19	2019-20	2020-21	2021-22	2022-23
KG	218	221	253	238	249	291
1	234	233	241	254	259	276
2	235	235	243	235	255	271
3	262	244	247	239	245	279
4	281	269	249	237	240	264
5	283	289	278	242	245	255
6	284	303	299	273	252	252
7	285	299	313	304	284	261
8	327	294	307	305	308	282
9	343	321	305	305	301	314
10	302	347	320	300	303	303
11	374	308	348	303	300	312
12	310	371	302	348	299	295

Sources: ODE Enrollment Data; District enrollment data



New Construction Starts



Four reasons for the k-4 enrollment increase:

- 1) Pandemic's impact on holding students entrance in kindergarten - According to the Ohio Department of Education, enrollment in kindergarten decreased by 8% between fall of 2019 and fall of 2020. This is reflected in the live births vs kindergarten enrollment chart with those students beginning kindergarten the following year. ("Data Insights: How the Pandemic is Affecting the 2020-2021 School Year | Ohio Department of Education")
- 2) Pandemic's impact on birth rates, slight increase - According to the U.S. Census Bureau, birth rates have been in a steady decline since 2008. Even fewer babies were born during the COVID-19 pandemic, which is evident in the live births graph. Birth rates are slowly rising following the pandemic. (Morse)
- 3) New housing starts over the past few years - New housing starts remained steady from 2015-2019, with an increase in 2018. Housing starts increased in 2020 and 2021, which is consistent with national trends. Nationally, construction slowed in 2022 due to rising interest rates. ("New Residential Construction Press Release") (Burns and Simao)
- 4) New PreK-5 building - The new building has created community interest in enrolling students in the public school system.

Recommendations & Conclusions:

Conclusion - Following the analysis of the district's data we believe that enrollment will return to pre-pandemic trends. The recent increase is likely a short-lived trend, though the District should continue to monitor future kindergarten enrollment for further variances.

Recommendation - Track and review census data to kindergarten (1-5 year olds) enrollment year-over-year.



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